

Grammar

Past Perfect (had + past participle)

We form the Past Perfect with had + the past participle of the verb. We use it for an action that happened before a specific past time, or before another past action.

Past Perfect, had + fiilin üçüncü hali (past participle) ile oluşturulur. Belirli bir geçmiş zamandan önce ya da geçmişteki başka bir olaydan önce gerçekleşen bir eylemi anlatmak için kullanılır.

When? We use the Past Perfect to show the earlier of two past actions, often with time markers like 'before', 'after', 'already', 'by the time', 'when' and 'never...before'.

İki geçmiş eylemden daha önce gerçekleşeni belirtmek için Past Perfect kullanılır; genellikle 'before', 'after', 'already', 'by the time', 'when' ve 'never...before' gibi zaman ifadeleriyle birlikte kullanılır.

Positive

- She had finished the report before the meeting started.
- They had already left when we arrived.

Negative

- He had not seen the message before he replied.
- We hadn't visited that city before last summer.

Question

- Had you finished your homework before dinner?
- Had she ever travelled abroad before that trip?

Short answers

- Yes, I had. / No, I hadn't.
- Yes, she had. / No, she hadn't.

Common mistakes

- ~~When I arrived, the film already started.~~ → **When I arrived, the film had already started.**
- ~~She had went to Paris before she moved to London.~~ → **She had gone to Paris before she moved to London.**
- ~~By the time he was twenty, he lived in three countries.~~ → **By the time he was twenty, he had lived in three countries.**

1. By the time she was eighteen, she _____ (travel) to five different countries.

2. Choose the correct sentence.

- a. When we got home, it started to rain.
- b. When we got home, it had started to rain.
- c. When we got home, it has started to rain.
- d. When we got home, it starts to rain.

3. She had never met him before that party. — True / False

4. He _____ his keys, so he couldn't get into the house.

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- a. lost
 - b. had lost
 - c. loses
 - d. has lost

5. Put the words in order: (already / the / had / bus / left / when / I arrived)

6. _____ you ever _____ (be) to that museum before last week's trip?

7. Combine using the Past Perfect: The train left. I got to the station five minutes later. (*By the time...*)

8. Which sentence uses the Past Perfect correctly?

- a. I hadn't eaten anything before the show start.
- b. I hadn't eaten anything before the show started.
- c. I don't eaten anything before the show started.
- d. I not ate anything before the show started.

9. Rewrite as one sentence using the Past Perfect: She finished her project. Then she went to bed. (*After...*)

10. The city _____ completely (change) by the time she returned after twenty years abroad.

11. Choose the best continuation: 'By the time the film finished, most of the audience...'

- a. fell asleep.
- b. had fallen asleep.
- c. falls asleep.
- d. has fallen asleep.

Past Perfect with time expressions (before, after, already, by the time, never...before)

Time expressions such as 'before', 'after', 'already', 'by the time' and 'never...before' are often used with the Past Perfect to make the sequence of past events clear.

'Before', 'after', 'already', 'by the time' ve 'never...before' gibi zaman ifadeleri, geçmişteki olayların sırasını netleştirmek için genellikle Past Perfect ile birlikte kullanılır.

When? We choose the time expression depending on which action we want to highlight as earlier, and we combine it with the Past Perfect for that earlier action.

Hangi eylemin daha önce gerçekleştiğini vurgulamak istediğimize göre zaman ifadesini seçeriz ve bu daha önceki eylemi Past Perfect ile birleştiririz.

Positive

- By the time we got there, the show had already begun.
- After she had finished her studies, she started working.

Negative

- Before the interview, he hadn't prepared any questions.
- By the time I called, they hadn't left yet.

Question

- Had you ever visited that country before your trip last year?

Short answers

- Yes, I had. / No, I hadn't.
- Yes, they had. / No, they hadn't.

- By the time you got home, had your family already eaten?

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Common mistakes

- ~~By the time she arrived, we finish the cake.~~ → **By the time she arrived, we had finished the cake.**
- ~~It was the first time I have seen snow.~~ → **It was the first time I had seen snow.**
- ~~After she had arrived home, she was calling her mother.~~ → **After she had arrived home, she called her mother.**

1. _____ the time she called, I _____ (already leave) the office.
2. It was the first time he _____ a live concert.
 - a. saw
 - b. had seen
 - c. has seen
 - d. sees
3. After they had eaten dinner, they went for a walk. — *True / False*
4. Join using 'before': She locked the door. Then she left the house.
5. Choose the correct sentence.
 - a. Never before I had travelled so far.
 - b. I had never travelled so far before.
 - c. I have never travelled so far before that.
 - d. I never had travelled so far before.
6. Combine with 'by the time': The guests left. We hadn't cleaned the kitchen yet.
7. It was the first time she _____ (be) responsible for organising an event on her own.